

CS 2210 — Data Structures and Algorithms

Assignment 2

Due Date: February 14 at 11:55 pm

Total marks: 20

In this assignment you need to write a lossless file compression program in Java. You will be provided with a decompression program, which receives as input a compressed file produced by your program and gives as output the original uncompressed file.

You need to implement at least 3 Java classes: `Record`, `HashDictionary`, and `FileCompress`. You can implement more classes if you need to. You **must** write all the code yourself. You cannot use code from the textbook, the Internet, an AI chatbot, or any other sources. You **cannot** use the standard Java `Hashtable` class or method `hashCode()`.

1 Class Record

This class represents a record to be stored in a dictionary ADT that you must implement using a hash table, as described in the next section. This class will have two instance variables: `key` of type `String`, and `data` of type `int`. Instance variable `key` is the key attribute of a `Record` object.

For this class, you must implement all and only the following public methods:

- `public Record(String theKey, int theData)`: The constructor for the class that stores the values of the parameters in the corresponding instance variables.
- `public String getKey()`: Returns the value of instance variable `key`.
- `public int getData()`: Returns the value of instance variable `data`.
- `public boolean same(Record secondObject)`: Returns true if `this` object and `secondObject` have the same `key` and `data` attributes; returns false otherwise.

You can implement any other methods that you want to in this class, but they must be declared as private methods.

2 Class HashDictionary

This class implements a dictionary using a hash table **in which collisions are resolved using separate chaining**. You must design your hash functions so that they produce few collisions. Bad hash functions that induce many collisions will result in a low mark for you. This class must implement the provided Java interface `DictionaryADT.java`, so the header for this class must be

```
public class HashDictionary implements DictionaryADT
```

The public methods that you must implement in this class are the following:

- `public HashDictionary(int size)`: The constructor for the class. This method will create an empty hash table of the size specified in the parameter.
- `public int put(Record pair) throws DictionaryException`: Inserts `pair` in the dictionary. This method must throw a `DictionaryException` if a `Record` object with the same key attribute as `pair`, `pair.getKey()`, is already in the dictionary.

To determine how good your design is, we will count the number of collisions produced by your hash functions. To that effect, **this method must return the value 1** if the insertion of

object `pair` produces a collision, and it **must return the value 0** otherwise. In other words, if for example your hash function is `h(k)` and the name of your hash table is `T`, this method will return the value 1 if `T[h(pair.getKey())]` already stores one `Record` object; it will return 0 if `T[h(pair.getKey())]` is null.

- `public void remove(String key) throws DictionaryException`: Removes the `Record` object with the given `key` attribute from the dictionary. This method must throw a `DictionaryException` if no `Record` object in the table has the given `key` attribute.
- `public Record get(String key)`: Returns the `Record` object stored in the dictionary with the given `key` attribute, or null if no entry in the dictionary has the given `key` attribute.
- `public int numRecords()`: Returns the number of `Record` objects stored in the dictionary.

You can implement any other methods that you want to in this class, but they must be declared as `private` methods.

3 Class `FileCompress`

This class will have one instance variable `hashTable` of type `HashDictionary`. In this class you must implement the following public method

- `public FileCompress()`: The constructor for the class that will initialize `hashTable` by creating a `HashDictionary` object; the size of the hash table **must be a prime number** between 4,000 and 10,000.
- `public CompressedFile compressor(String fileName)`: The parameter `fileName` is the name of the file to be compressed. This method must implement the compression algorithm described in the next section and it must return an object of the provided class `CompressedFile`, which contains a reference to the compressed input file (this `CompressedFile` object will be used by some of the hidden tests that Gradercope will perform). Class `CompressedFile` is described below.

The first thing that you must do in method `compressor` is to create an object of the class `CompressedFile`:

```
CompressedFile outputFile = new CompressedFile(fileName);
```

Then you must open the input file using the provided `MyReader` class. You must use this class to open the file as otherwise some of the test cases that we will use will fail. To open the input file you can use this code:

```
MyReader inputFile = new MyReader(fileName);
```

The compressed file will be stored in a file with the same name as the input file, but with extension `".zzz"`. For example if the name of the input file is `test.txt` then the name of the compressed file will be `test.zzz`. Class `CompressedFile` will set the name of the output file.

You can implement any other methods that you want to in this class, but they must be declared as `private` methods.

3.1 The Compression Algorithm

After initializing `outputFile` and `inputFile`, the compression algorithm will store in a dictionary a set of `Record` objects that will be used to compress the input file. The maximum number of `Record` objects that will be stored in the dictionary is 4096 as explained in Section 3.2.

The input file could be a text file, an image file, an audio file, or any other kind of binary file, so we will consider that the input file is just a sequence of bytes. Recall that a byte consists of 8 bits, so there are 256 possible different bytes. Your program must initialize the hash table by storing in it 256 `Record` objects, each one corresponding to a different byte.

Let the different bytes be $b_0 = 00000000$, $b_1 = 00000001$, $b_2 = 00000010, \dots, b_{255} = 11111111$. Since each `Record` object has a `String` and an `int` attribute, how can we convert a byte into a `String` and into an `int` so we can store the different bytes in the dictionary? Since a byte is just a sequence of 8 bits, it can be readily interpreted as an integer, so b_0 represents the number 0, b_1 represents the number 1, and b_{255} represents the number 255.

Converting a byte into a `String` is just a bit harder. A byte can be converted into a `char` through casting. So, for example, $(\text{char})b_0$ is the NULL character, $(\text{char})b_1$ is the SOH character, $(\text{char})b_{97}$ is 'a', $(\text{char})b_{98}$ is 'b', and so on. An ASCII table contains the bit representation of each `char`; for your reference we posted an ASCII table in OWL.

Once we have converted a byte into a `char`, it is now easy to convert it into a `String` by using, for example, methods `String.valueOf(char ch)` or `Character.toString(char ch)`. Therefore, to initialize your hash table you could use an algorithm like this:

for $i \leftarrow 0$ to 255 **do**

 Store in the dictionary a new `Record` object with

- `data` = i and
- `key` = `String` obtained from character $(\text{char})i$.

The compression algorithm will map groups of bytes from the input file into integer codes; the compressed file will store these codes. The compression algorithm will read the input file one byte at a time. To read one byte from the input file you can use method `read()` from the provided `MyReader` class; note that this method converts the byte read into an integer value. The end of file is detected when the `read()` method returns the value `-1`.

Once the dictionary has been initialized and the input file has been opened the compression algorithm works as follows.

1. Assign the value 256 to some variable, say, n_c (this value 256 is the smallest integer that has not been assigned as `data` attribute to any of the `Record` objects stored in the dictionary). This variable n_c stores the code of the next `Record` object that will be inserted in the dictionary.
2. Read the first byte from the input file, convert it to a `String` and store it in some variable, say, s .
3. Repeatedly perform the following steps until the end of the input file has been reached or a string s is found that it is not the `key` attribute of any of the `Record` objects stored in the dictionary:
 - Read the next byte b from the input file
 - Convert b to a character c .
 - Append c to s .
4. If no `Record` object in the dictionary has key s , then let s' to be the string containing all characters from s except the last one; otherwise, set $s' = s$.

5. Find the **Record** object d with **key** attribute equal to s' ; let k be the integer code attribute of d .
6. Write k into the compressed file **outputFile** as specified in Section 3.4.
7. If all the input file has been processed, then close the input file using method **close()** from class **MyReader**. You must also close the output file as specified in Section 3.4 and then terminate.
8. If the number of **Record** objects stored in the dictionary is less than 4096, then create a new **Record** object d' with **key** attribute s and **data** attribute n_c and insert d' into the dictionary.
9. Delete from s all its characters, except the last one (so now string s has only one character).
10. Increase the value of n_c and then go back to Step 3.

In your code you should use meaningful names for the above variables s , s' , n_c , d , and d' .

3.2 Size of the HashDictionary

For very long input files the number of **Record** objects (**string,code**) that are inserted in the dictionary could be very large. In order to keep the size of the integer codes bounded as specified above, we impose a limit of 4096 on the maximum number of different **Record** objects that can be stored in the dictionary. Hence, every code that the algorithm writes to the compressed file will be 12 bits long (as $2^{12} = 4096$).

Important note. After your program has inserted 4096 records in the dictionary no more records can be added (as there are no more available integer codes). This is important, as otherwise your compressed file will not be decompressed correctly. If the dictionary already contains 4096 codes, then in Step 8 of the algorithm no new data will be inserted in the dictionary.

3.3 Example Showing Execution of the Compression Algorithm

To clarify the way in which the algorithm works, let us try it on a text input file that contains the string "aaabbbb". Remember that the dictionary initially contains 256 **Record** objects corresponding to the 256 different bytes that might appear in the input file.

The algorithm reads the first byte from the input file and converts it to the string $s = "a"$. The next character 'a' is read and appended to s to form the string "aa". Since "aa" is not in the dictionary, then in Steps 4 and 5 the algorithm creates the string $s' = "a"$ and gets from the dictionary the **data** attribute 97 of the **Record** object with **key** attribute "a". In Step 6, the algorithm writes the code 97 into the output file:

Input File	Compressed File	Dictionary
a aabbbb	97	...
		("a",97)
		...
		("b",98)
		...

In the above figure there is a box surrounding the part of the input that has already been processed.

Since there are fewer than 4096 objects in the dictionary a new **Record** object with **key** attribute $s = "aa"$ and **data** attribute $n_c = 256$ is inserted in the dictionary.

Input File	Compressed File	Dictionary
a aabbbb	97	...
		("a",97)
		...
		("b",98)
		...
		("aa",256)
		...

In Steps 9 and 10 s takes value "a" and n_c is increased to 257. Observe that so far the algorithm has only output code for the first character 'a' of the input file.

In the second iteration of Step 3, bytes are read from the input file and they are converted to characters which are appended to string s until the string "aab" is formed, since "aab" is not in the dictionary. String s' is now "aa" and the **Record** object with key s' has code $k = 256$, hence the value 256 is written to the output file. A new **Record** object with key s and code 257 is then added to the dictionary. Variable s then takes value "b" and n_c is increased 258.

Input File	Compressed File	HashDictionary
aaa bbbb	97 256	...
		("a",97)
		...
		("b",98)
		...
		("aa",256)
		...
		("aab",257)
		...

At this point the algorithm has processed the input "aaa". In Step 3 only one character is appended to s to get $s = "bb"$ as "bb" is not in the dictionary. The **Record** object in the dictionary with key $s' = "b"$ has code 98, so the value 98 is written to the output file. Then a **Record** object with key "bb" and code 258 is inserted in the dictionary. Finally, s takes value "b" and $n_c = 259$.

Input File	Compressed File	Dictionary
aaab bbb	97 256 98	...
		("a",97)
		...
		("b",98)
		...
		("aa",256)
		...
		("aab",257)
		...
		("bb",258)
		...

So far the algorithm has already processed "aaab" from the input. In Step 3 string s takes value "bbb". The **Record** object in the dictionary with key $s' = "bb"$ has code 258, so this value 258 is written to the output file. A **Record** with key "bbb" and code 259 is added to the dictionary, s is set to "b" and $n_c = 260$.

Input File	Compressed File	Dictionary
aaabbbb	b	...
		("a",97)
		...
		("b",98)
		...
		("aa",256)
		...
		("aab",257)
		...
		("bb",258)
		...
		("bbb",259)
		...

The only character from the input file that has not been processed is the final ‘b’. In Step 3 the algorithm does not change s as the end of the input file has been reached. Therefore $s' = s$ and the code 98 is written to the output file. Finally, the output file is closed and the algorithm terminates. The 7 character input file has been compressed to a sequence of 5 integers.

Input File	Compressed File	HashDictionary
aaabbbb	97 256 98 258 98	...
		("a",97)
		...
		("b",98)
		...
		("aa",256)
		...
		("aab",257)
		...
		("bb",258)
		...
		("bbb",259)
		...

Note that in the above example, for illustration purposes, the **Record** objects were shown in increasing order of code value in the dictionary, but this will not be the case in your program since you will implement the dictionary using a hash table.

3.4 Writing Integer Codes to the Compressed File

In Step 6 of the compression algorithm 12-bit codes must be written to the output file. This can be done using method **output** from class **CompressedFile**:

```
outputFile.output(int code);
```

where **outputFile** is the **CompressedFile** object created the the beginning of method **compressor**.

Since it is only possible to write whole bytes to a file, the above method might temporarily keep in a buffer 4 bits from a code. These 4 bits are concatenated with the 12 bits of the next code to produce a 2-byte output. If this is confusing to you, you do not need to understand the explanation of how method **output** works, you just need to understand how to use it.

It is very important that at the end of method `compressor` you write to the output file any bits left in the buffer, and then close the output file:

```
outputFile.flush();
outputFile.close();
```

If you do not close the output file it will not be saved in disk.

4 Running and Testing your Program

Provided class `Compress` contains the `main` method. To run your program from the terminal, first compile it:

```
javac Compress.java
```

and then run it:

```
java Compress file
```

where `file` is the name of the input file. If you wish to run your program in Eclipse you must set the input file as the command line argument. Please read the tutorials in OWL under the tab FAQ if you need help setting up Eclipse.

We will perform two kinds of tests on your program: (1) tests for your implementation of the dictionary, and (2) tests for your file compressor. For testing the dictionary we will run a test program called `TestDict` which checks whether your dictionary works as specified. We will supply you with a copy of `TestDict` so you can use it to test your implementation. Note that `TestDict` cannot perform an exhaustive testing of your implementation. You are expected to run additional tests on your own to ensure that your program works correctly.

For testing your file compressor we will give your program some input files, check the sizes of the compressed files, and then we will decompress them and verify that the original files are restored.

The Java program to decompress files is given to you. Compile the program

```
javac Uncompress.java
```

and then run it by typing:

```
java Uncompress file
```

where `file` is the name of the compressed file **without** the “.zzz” extension. The program will produce a file with extension “.unc”. You can use, for example, the `cmp` UNIX utility or the `fc` windows program to compare the original file with the decompressed one. For example, by typing

```
cmp file1 file2
```

`cmp` will report the first character where the two files differ, if any. If the files are identical, `cmp` terminates without producing any output.

5 Provided Java Classes

5.1 MyReader

This class provides the following public methods.

- `MyReader(String fileName)`: The constructor for the class.
- `int read()`: Reads one byte from the input file and converts it to an int.
- `void close()`: Closes the input file.

5.2 CompressedFile

This class provides the following public methods.

- `CompressedFile(String fileName)`: The constructor for the class.
- `void output(int pcode)`: Writes 12 bit codes to the output file, storing groups of 4 bits in a buffer when required.
- `void flush()`: Writes to the output file the last set of 4 bits of the compressed file, if any.
- `void close()`: Closes the output file so it is saved in disk.

5.3 Compress and Uncompress

Classes to compress and decompress a file.

6 Coding Style

Your mark will be based partly on your coding style.

- Variable and method names should reflect their purpose in the program.
- Comments and indenting should be used to improve readability.
- No instance variables should be used unless they contain data which needs to be maintained in an object from call to call to tis methods. In other words, variables which are needed only inside methods, whose value does not have to be remembered until the next method call, should be declared inside those methods.
- All instance variables should be declared **private**, to maximize information hiding. Any access to these variables should be done with accessor methods (like `getKey()` for `Record`).

7 Marking

Your mark will be computed as follows.

- Program compiles, produces meaningful output: 2 marks.
- `HashDictionary` tests: 5 marks.
- `FileCompress` tests: 5 marks.
- Coding style: 2 marks.
- Hash table implementation: 3 marks.
- `FileCompress` program implementation: 3 marks.

8 Handing In Your Program

To submit your program, login to OWL and submit your java files through Gradescope using the link contained in the tab for Assignment 2. **Please make sure you submit your .java files and not your .class files.** DO NOT compress your files. DO NOT add a `package` statement at the top of your java classes.

If you re-submit your program we will only mark the latest version and will deduct marks accordingly if it is late.